Recording Consents — Staff Guide

This is a quick, click-by-click guide for front-desk and clinical staff on how to **record a patient's consent** with the Consent Capture plugin, right from the patient's chart. No setup knowledge needed. If you can open a patient chart, you can do this.

What this covers: opening the Consents window, recording a consent, handling a signed paper ("Written") consent, viewing a consent already on file, and renewing an expired one.

> This guide is for the people *recording* consents. If you're the administrator setting the plugin up (credentials, which consents exist, wording), see **SETUP_GUIDE.md**.

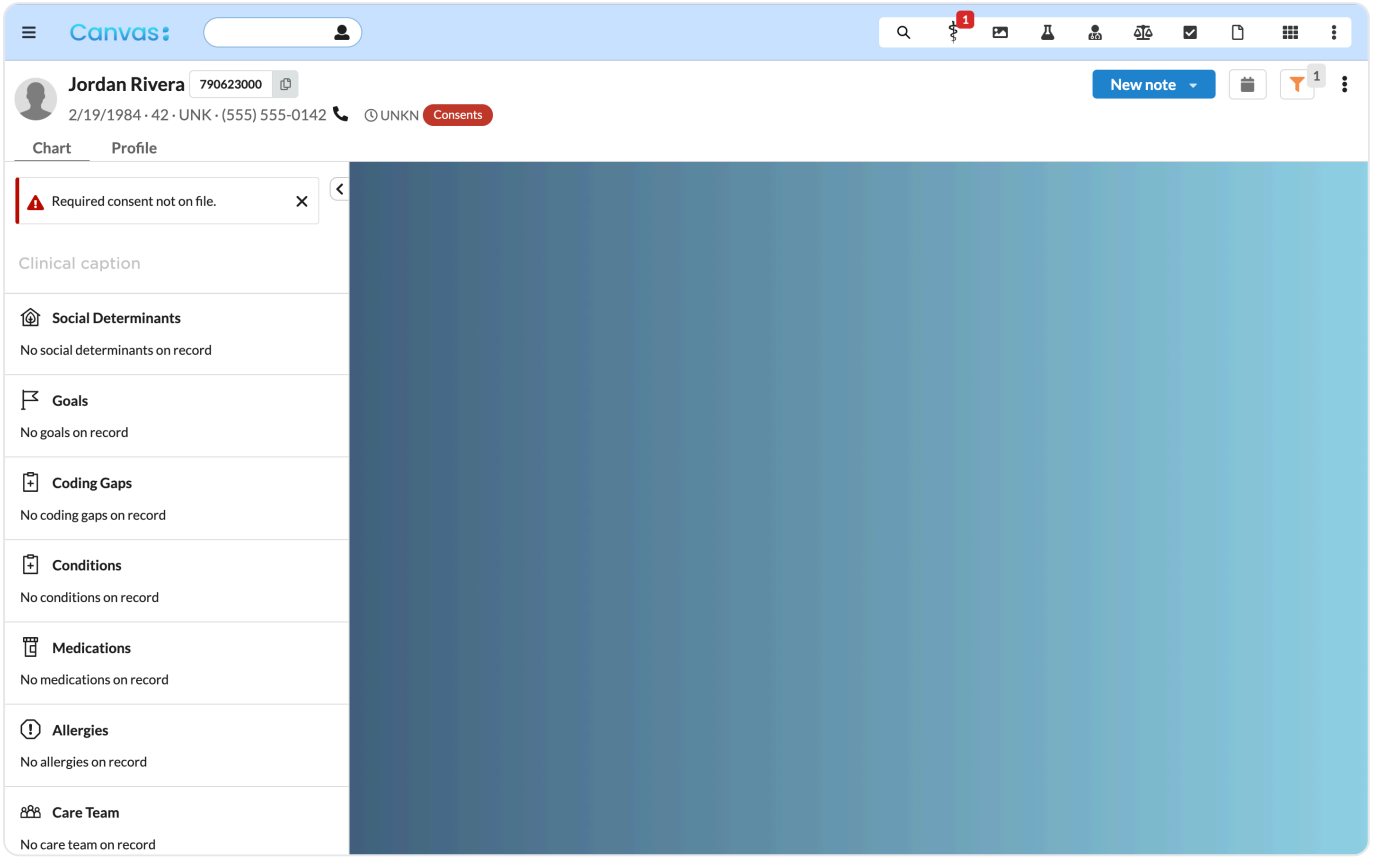
> *The screenshots of the consent window below use sample data for illustration. Your practice's consents, wording, and patient details will look different.*

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1. Opening the Consents window

Open the patient's chart. There's one way to open Consents, plus one reminder:

- **"Consents" button** at the top of the chart. It's **always there**; it's **red when the patient still needs a required consent** and a neutral **gray** once everything required is on file. Click it either way to open Consents.
- **Red banner reading "Required consent not on file."** This is a *reminder*, not a button. It tells you the patient owes a required consent. Use the red button to open Consents. The banner clears on its own once the required consent is recorded.



> If the patient is inactive or deceased, the button stays gray (never red) and the banner won't show. You can still open Consents from the button.

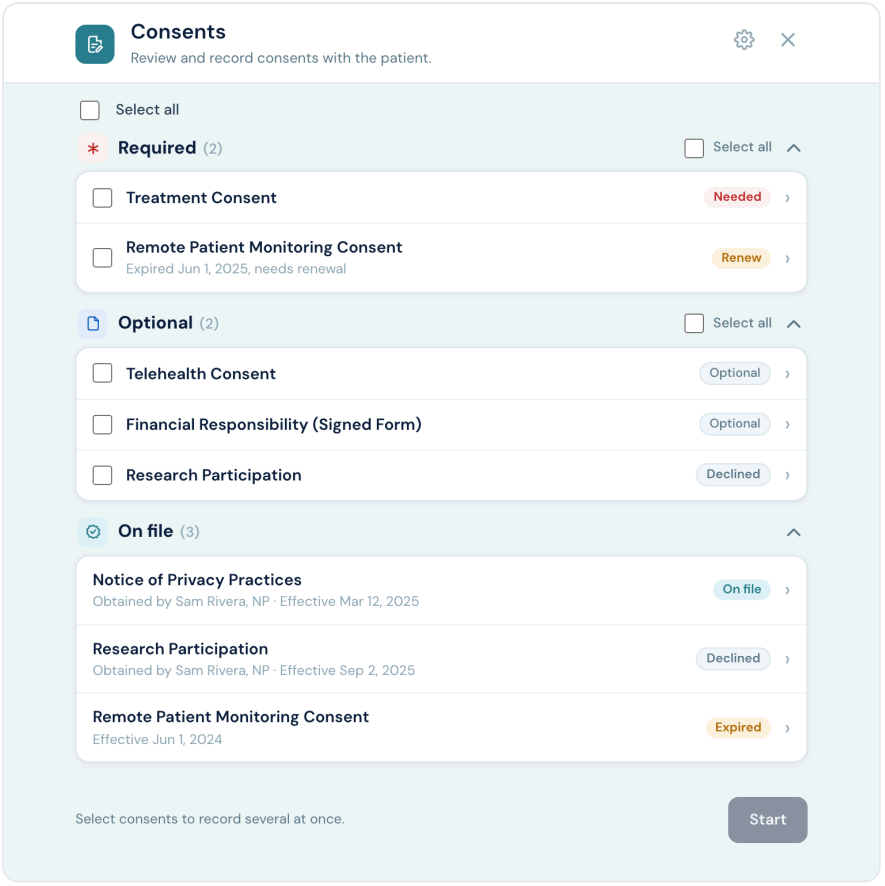
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2. The Consents window (the "hub")

When Consents opens, you'll see the patient's consents sorted into up to three groups. Each row shows the consent name, a colored status tag, and a › arrow.

- **Required** — consents the patient must have. Tags you'll see:
  - **Needed** (red) — never recorded. Record it.
  - **Renew** (amber) — was recorded but has **expired**. The row shows when it expired.
- **Optional** — consents you *can* record but aren't required. Tags: **Optional**, or **Renew** if a previous one expired.
- **On File** — the patient's consent **history**. Tags: **On file** (green) or **Expired** (amber). Each row shows the effective date and expiration (or "No expiration"). Clicking one **opens the recorded document** (see section 6). This group includes consents recorded elsewhere, not just ones you record here.

Every group starts open. Click a group's heading to fold it closed or open it again.



To **record** a consent, click any row under **Required** or **Optional**.

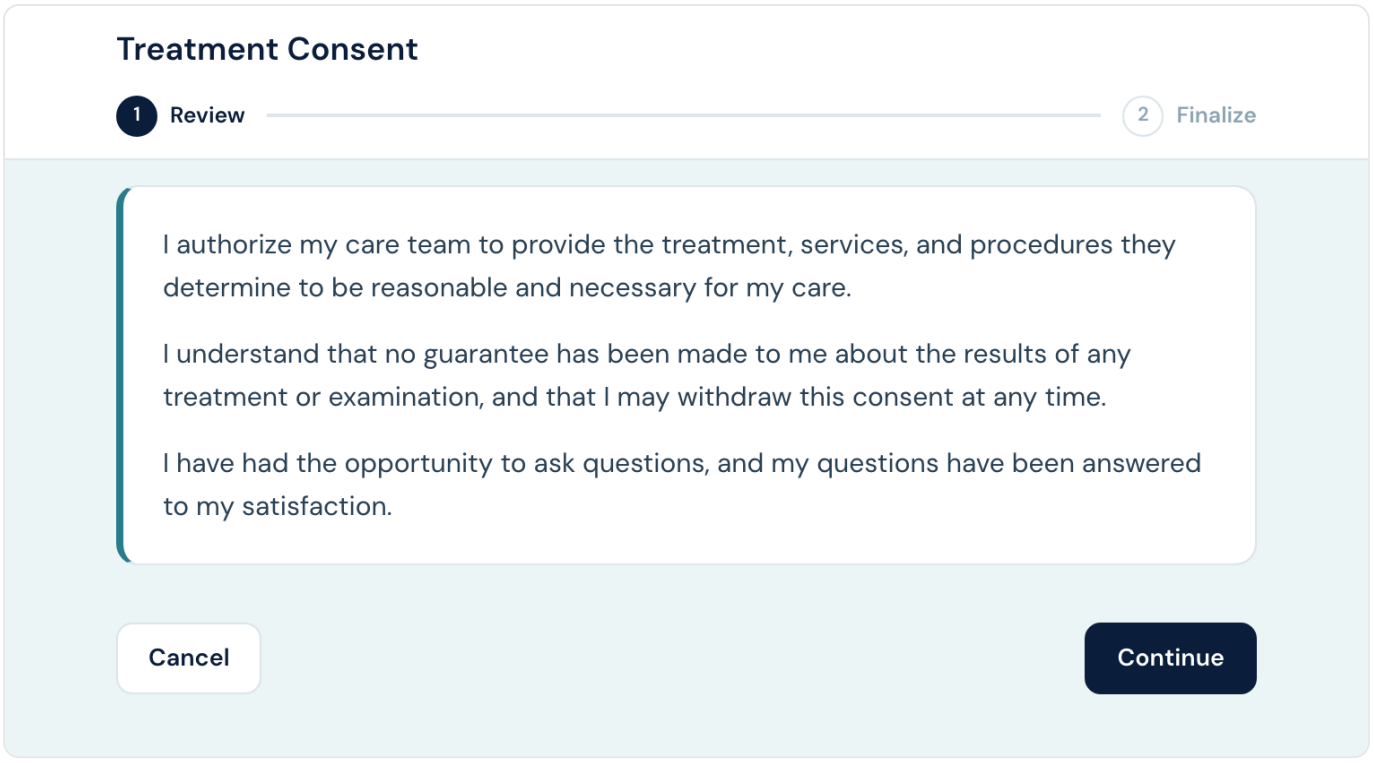
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3. Recording a consent (the normal flow)

After you click a consent, a short two-step wizard opens. The steps are shown at the top: **Review → Finalize**.

Step 1 — Review

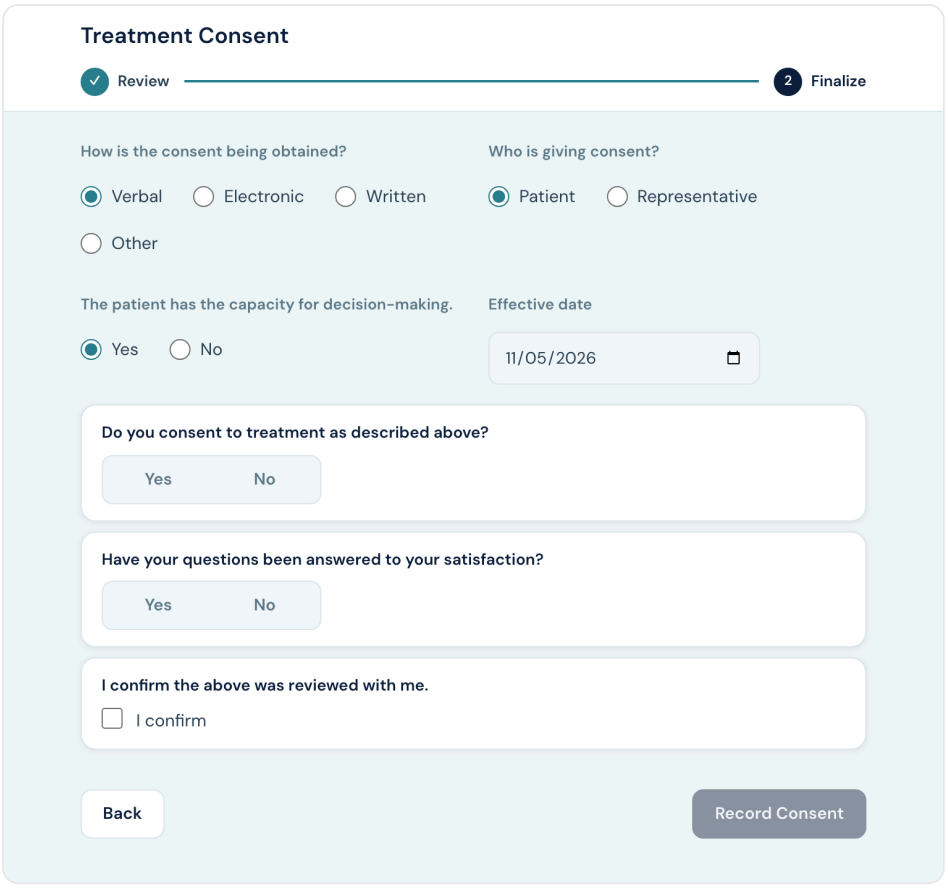
You'll see the consent's wording. **Read it with the patient.** When you're ready, click **Continue**. (To go back to the list, click **Cancel**.)



Step 2 — Finalize

Depending on how this consent is set up, you may see some or all of the following. Fill in what's shown:

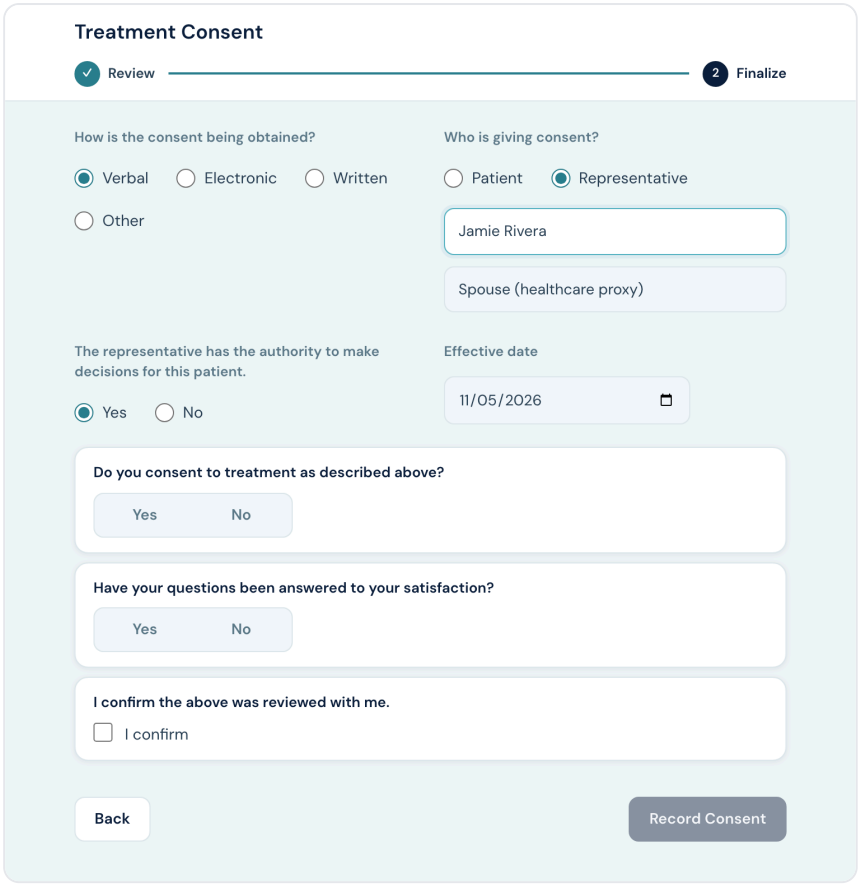
1. **How is the consent being obtained?** — pick one: **Verbal**, **Electronic**, **Written**, or **Other** (only the options your practice enabled appear). If you pick **Written**, a note tells you that you'll add the signed form on the next step (see section 4).
2. **Who is giving consent?** — **Patient** or **Representative**. If you pick Representative, enter their **full name** and their **relationship to the patient** (for example: parent, healthcare proxy). Both are required.
3. **Capacity attestation** — if this consent requires it, you'll see a statement — *"The patient has the capacity for decision-making."* (or, for a representative, *"The representative has the authority for decision-making."*) — with **Yes / No** buttons. **Yes** is pre-selected; leave it on Yes to attest. Selecting **No** shows a notice and blocks recording until capacity is confirmed.
4. **Questions** — answer any questions shown (Yes/No, a confirmation checkbox, or a short typed answer). Some questions are required. If a question **must be answered Yes** and you answer No, a warning appears and the consent can't be recorded. *(Questions do not appear for **Written** consents — the signed form is the record.)*
5. **Effective date** — defaults to today. Change it only if the consent was given on a different day.



When everything's filled in, click **Record Consent**.

> The button stays greyed out until required questions are answered, the capacity attestation (if shown) is confirmed, and — if applicable — the representative's name and relationship are filled in.

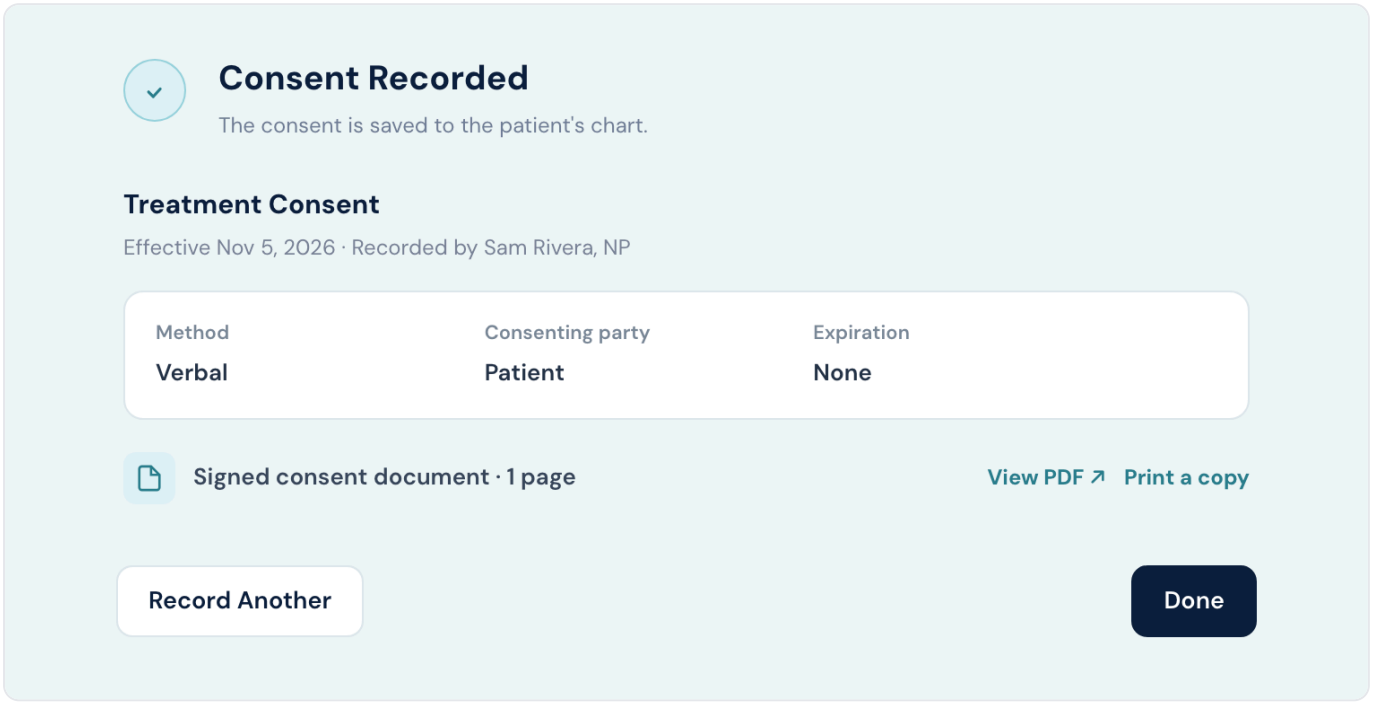
When **Representative** is selected, the name and relationship fields appear:



Done

You'll see a green checkmark and **"Consent Recorded."** From here you can:

- **Record Another** — go back to the list to record another consent, or
- **Done** — close the window.



The consent now appears under **On File**, and if it was the last required one, the button turns from red to gray and the banner clears on their own.

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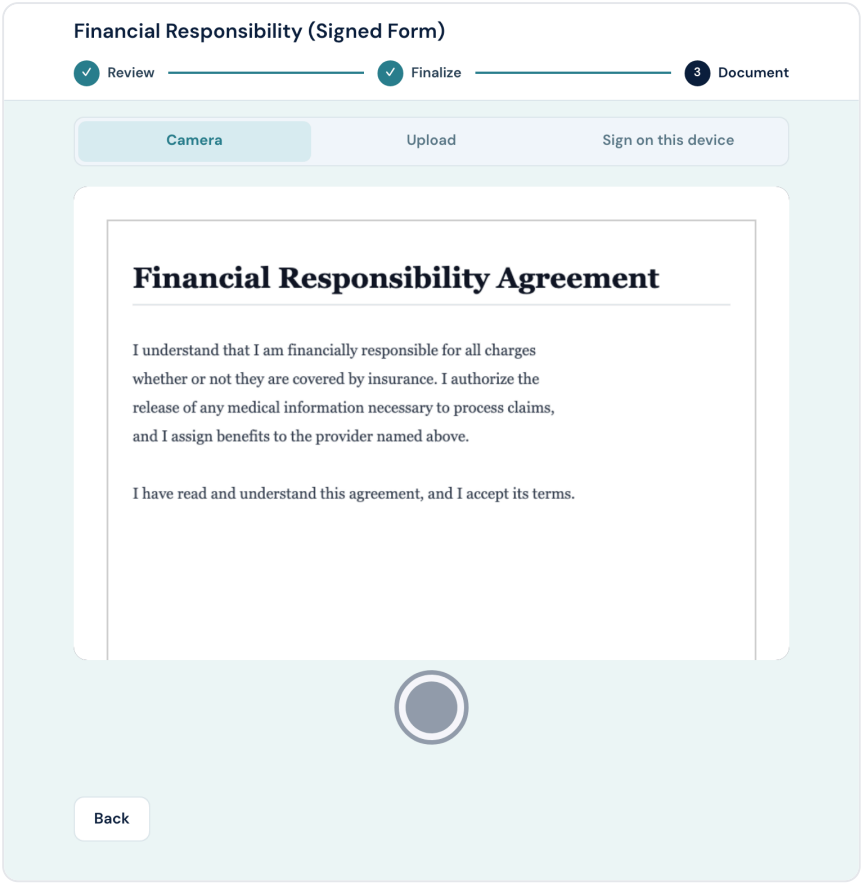
4. Recording a "Written" (signed paper) consent

If you chose **Written** as the method, no on-screen questions are asked (the signed form is the record). Clicking **Continue** takes you to a **Document** step so you can attach the signed form. You can use the device camera or upload a file.

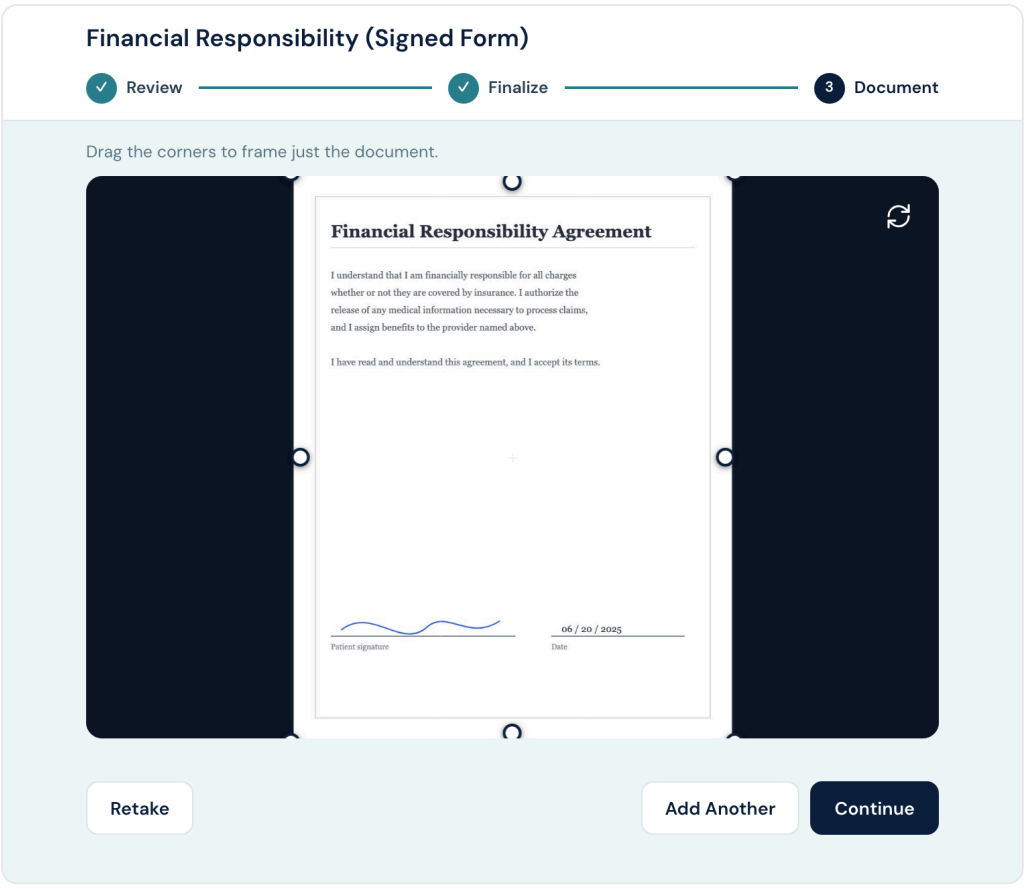
At the top you'll see two tabs, **Camera** and **Upload**, and a third, **Sign on this device**, when your practice turned on device signing for this consent.

Option A — Camera

1. On the **Camera** tab, take a photo of the signed page:
   - On an iPad or phone, tap **Take Photo**. Your device's camera opens; take the photo there.
   - On a computer, point the camera at the page and tap the round **shutter** button.



2. The photo opens on the **crop** screen. Drag the corners to frame just the document (use the rotate button if it's sideways), then:
   - Tap **Add Another** to keep this page and take the next one.
   - Tap **Continue** to keep this page and go to the page list.
   - Tap **Retake** to discard it and try again.



3. While you take more pages, a strip under the camera shows the pages so far and how many there are. Tap it to go to the page list.

> If the camera doesn't work on your device, switch to the **Upload** tab.

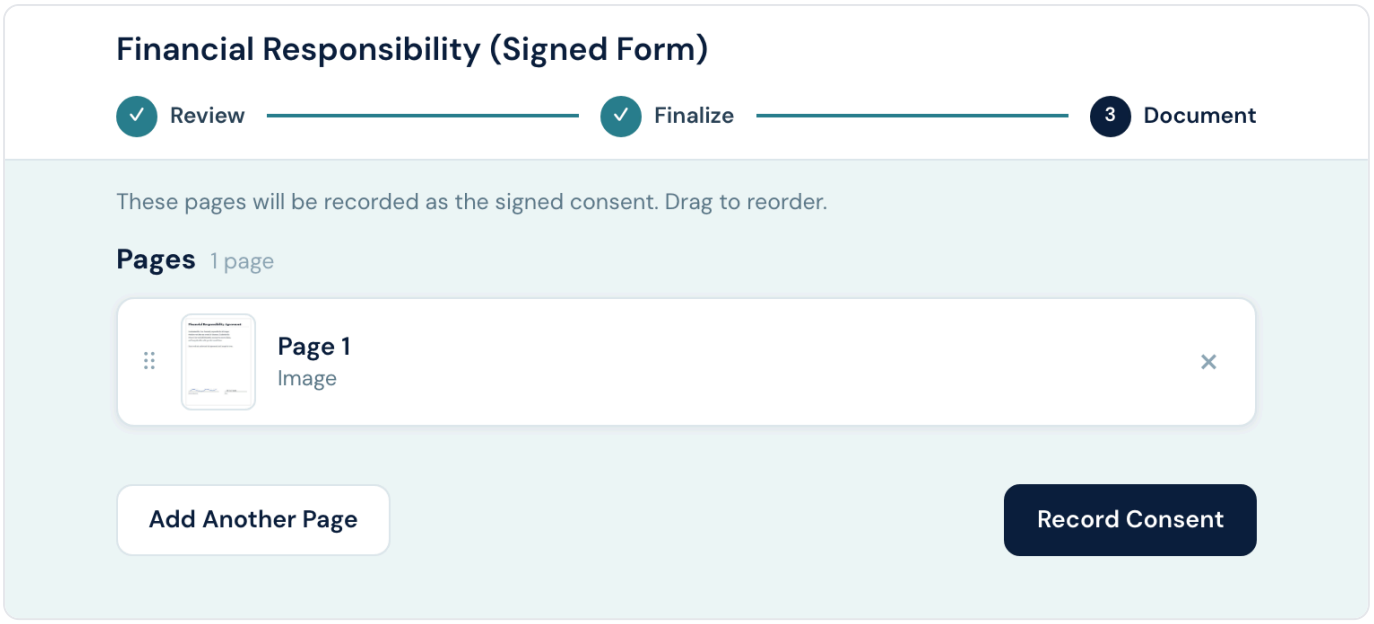
Option B — Upload

1. Tap the **Upload** tab, then **Choose files**.
2. Pick one or more **images or a PDF** of the signed document.
3. Images open on the crop screen one at a time. Crop each one, then tap **Add Another** or **Continue**.

Review the pages and record

On the **Pages** screen you'll see every page you added:

- **Drag** the pages by the handle to put them in the right order.
- Tap the **×** on a page to remove it.
- Tap **Add Another Page** to capture or upload more.



When the pages look right, tap **Record Consent**. The plugin assembles them into one document, files it, and shows the **Consent Recorded** screen.

Option C — Sign on this device

The patient or representative signs on your device instead of on paper. The Document step opens on this tab when it's available.

1. Tap **Continue**. The screen says **Hand the device to the signer** and shows who is signing. Hand the device over.
2. The signer reads the consent, signs in the box, and taps **Accept and Sign**. Depending on your practice's settings they can sign with a finger or stylus, a mouse or trackpad, or type their name, and may be asked for a printed name.
3. A **Thank you** screen asks them to hand the device back. Tap **Continue**.
4. On **Review consent**, check the signature and tap **Record Consent**.

If the printed or typed name doesn't match the person giving consent, a notice appears on **Review consent**. Choose **Same person, keep as is**, or **Use "[name]" as representative**, which updates **Who is giving consent?** and asks the signer to confirm their signature again. **Record Consent** stays unavailable until you choose.

The consent is saved as **Written**. The PDF shows the signature, the signer, and the time, and On File shows how it was signed.

4a. Recording several consents at once

1. On the Consents window, check the consents to record, or use **Select all**. Selecting a consent's name still opens it on its own.
2. Tap **Start**. Choose how each consent is being obtained, then answer **Who is giving consent?**, capacity, and the effective date once for all of them.
3. Tap **Continue**, hand the device to the signer, and tap **Start Signing**. The signer goes through each consent ("Consent 1 of 3"), answers its questions, and taps **Accept and Sign** or **Skip**.
4. On **Review consents**, each consent shows its status. Use **Sign now** for one that wasn't signed, or **Decline** when the patient declines it.
5. Tap **Record Consents**. Only finished consents are recorded; the rest stay Needed.

A declined consent shows as **Declined** under On File and no longer turns the **Consents** button red. It stays in the list with a gray **Declined** tag, so it can be recorded later if the patient changes their mind.

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5. Renewing an expired consent

A consent tagged **Renew** (amber) has expired and needs to be recaptured.

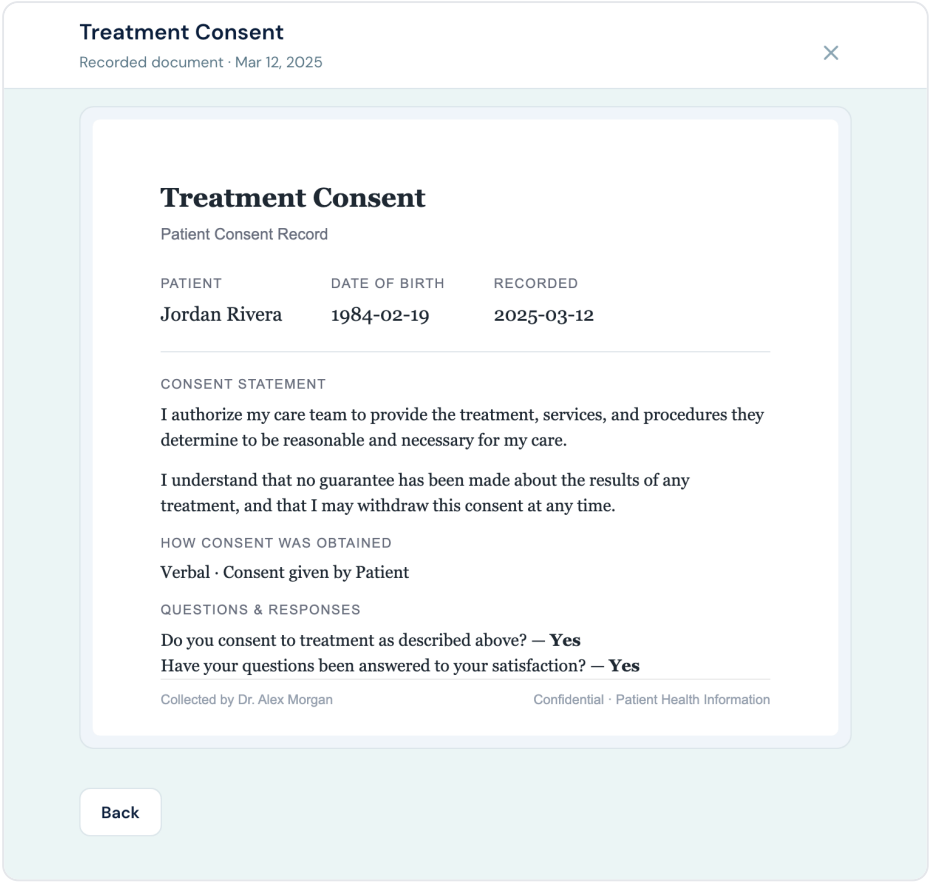
1. Open Consents and click the consent tagged **Renew** (under **Required** or **Optional**).
2. Record it exactly like a normal consent (sections 3–4).

The new consent replaces the expired one under **On File**.

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6. Viewing a consent that's already on file

1. Open Consents.
2. Under **On File**, click the consent you want to see.
3. The recorded document opens in a viewer. Click **Back** to return to the list, or the **×** to close.



> Some consents on file may have been recorded elsewhere in Canvas. They still show here so you have the full picture. If a row has no attached document, the viewer will say so.

Good to know

- **One record per consent type.** Recording a consent again (a renewal, or a correction) replaces the previous one for that consent. The patient won't end up with duplicates.
- **The button color and banner are automatic.** The button turns red (and the banner appears) when a required consent is missing, and both clear once it's recorded — the button stays as a neutral gray entry point. You don't turn them off.
- **The person recording is you.** The consent is filed under your signed-in Canvas account, so you don't enter your own name anywhere.
- **HIPAA authorizations.** When a consent is a HIPAA authorization, select **Print a copy** after recording and give the copy to the signer.

If something goes wrong

What you see	What to do
"Record Consent" is greyed out	Answer all required questions and confirm the capacity attestation if one is shown. If a representative is giving consent, fill in their name and relationship. If a question must be Yes, it can't be recorded on No.
"Please select how the consent was obtained"	Choose a method (Verbal / Electronic / Written / Other) before recording.
"Could not reach the server" / "Could not record consent"	Try again. If it keeps happening, tell your administrator (it may be a configuration issue).
Camera is blocked or unavailable (Written consents)	Use the **Upload** tab instead.
A consent you expected isn't in the list to record	It may be hidden by your administrator. Ask them to enable it in Consent Settings.
The document won't open from On File	That consent may not have an attached file, or it was recorded without one. The viewer will tell you.